

# SALMA AKTER

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## EDUCATION

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### M.Sc. in Oceanography

2024 - 2025

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology | Sylhet, Bangladesh

CGPA: 3.63

### B.Sc. (Honors) in Oceanography

2019 – 2024

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology | Sylhet, Bangladesh

CGPA: 3.30

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Marine & Coastal Ecology; Benthic and Sediment Ecology; Fisheries Ecology; Phytoplankton; Invertebrates; Coral Reef Ecology; Marine Pollution and Microplastics; GIS/Spatial Analysis; Biodiversity Monitoring and Conservation.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### Research Project

- **Diversity and abundance of Macrobenthos between Salimpur Coast and Shahpuree Island, Bangladesh**

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology, Sylhet, Bangladesh | January 2024

- Conducted field-based sampling and identification of macrobenthos across South-East coastal sites; assessed species richness, abundance, and ecological indicators.
- Computed biodiversity indices and produced GIS-based maps to visualize spatial variation and key hotspots.

### Academic Projects

- **Spatial analysis of sea surface temperature (SST) and chlorophyll concentration in the North Sea**

- Analyzed SST and chlorophyll-a variability using satellite/remote-sensing datasets and GIS-based spatial analysis.

- **Role of Cyclone Sidr on chlorophyll distribution in the Bay of Bengal**

- Assessed cyclone-driven changes in chlorophyll concentration and SST using satellite data and oceanographic analysis workflows.

- **Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) on Temukhi Point and surrounding areas, Sylhet**

- Conducted field data collection across nine urban locations to assess pollution impacts and propose sustainable management recommendations.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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### Research Assistant - GIZ Bangladesh

- **Biodiversity Assessment in Naf & Saint Martin Marine Protected Areas | 2025**

- Conducted district-wide coastal field data collection across Cox's Bazar (marine side, end-to-end).
- Led fishermen surveys and field-level fish identification with photo documentation; recorded bycatch and non-fish taxa.
- Managed data capture and quality assurance using Kobo Toolbox.

### **Intern - Cosmo Foundation**

#### **Saint Martin's Island (Coral Conservation & Marine Biodiversity)**

- Supported coral conservation initiatives and marine biodiversity field activities in Saint Martin's Island.
- Assisted with coral vulnerability assessment and reef health data collection.
- Coordinated with research labs on coral restoration and ecological monitoring.

#### **Intern Projects**

- **Empowering Coastal Communities and Strengthening Marine Biodiversity Conservation in Bangladesh**
  - Developed proposal components for integrated approaches across five marine protected areas and 19 coastal districts of the Bay of Bengal.
- **Coral restoration and mapping in Saint Martin's Island**
  - Contributed to planning and documentation for restoration and GIS-based mapping activities.

### **POSTER PRESENTATION**

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#### **International Conference on Sustainable Fisheries 2025, Sylhet Agricultural University (SAU), Sylhet**

Poster: Diversity and abundance of Macrobenthos between Salimpur Coast and Shahpuree Island, Bangladesh.

### **TECHNICAL SKILLS**

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**Software Skills:** ArcGIS, QGIS

**Programming Language:** Python, R

**Data Collection Tools:** Kobo Toolbox

**Tools:** Microsoft Word, Microsoft PowerPoint, Microsoft Excel

**Oceanography Tools:** Grab sampler, water multi-parameter meter, Mini CTD, plankton net, algal torch

**Languages:** English, Bangla

### **CERTIFICATIONS**

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- Volunteer, International Symposium on Marine Resource Management - Shahjalal University of Science and Technology (SUST), Sylhet.

### **MEMBERSHIPS**

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- **SUST Career Club** - Departmental Executive (Mar 2019 - Feb 2020)
- **Chokh Film Society** - Workshop and Study Circle Secretary (Oct 2022 - Nov 2023)

### **REFERENCES**

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#### **Dr. Subrata Sarker**

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Department of Oceanography, SUST  
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